example and inspiration, its society to be emulated and actively helped during a time of massive social and political transformation.

This is by no means a full picture of Indian attitudes to China and the Chinese during the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries – that would be another book. In any case, as things stand, Chinese attitudes towards India and Indians are better documented. On Indian attitudes, there has been much less research, though historians such as Sen have written about Tagore, his pan-Asianism, and his efforts at India–China artistic and intellectual collaboration at Cheena Bhavan.[32] Rahul Sagar's *Ideas of India*, a massive online archiving of Indian writings in English from 1825 to 1950, suggests that China did feature fairly extensively – unfortunately, I became aware of this trove too late to access its content.[33] On the whole, it is safe to say that the views of key Indian nationalist leaders and personalities were positive if not admiring of China's classical culture but also of its modernizing impulses, including its resistance to Western and Japanese imperialism.

Perceptions in More Contemporary Times

How do Indians and Chinese see each other in more recent times? The short answer is not very positively. Since 1962, Indian admiration and affinity for China has been replaced by a sneaking/fearful admiration of its rise to power mixed with a sense of betrayal/humiliation as a result of the war. In China, the negative views of India have continued: nineteenth-century disdain combined with a degree of indifference. The Chinese increasingly see their country as a great power with no peer except the US, and Americans are their main reference point. This mutual alienation between Indians and Chinese somewhat overstates feelings on both sides. There are those who see something to like and engage in the other, and there is curiosity, even respect. Yet, the negative views of each other's society and at the same time ignorance of each other is palpable.